11-29 第二篇

Wetlands: Nature's Hidden Treasures

Wetlands are areas where water covers the soil or is present near the surface for much of the year. Swamps, marshes, and bogs are all types of wetlands. They may not look as dramatic as mountains or oceans, but wetlands play a vital role in maintaining the health of the environment. They filter water, reduce flooding, and provide habitats for thousands of species. [1] Wetlands are among the most productive ecosystems on Earth, supporting an extraordinary range of life and performing essential services that benefit both nature and human communities.

Wetlands act as natural water filters. As water flows through wetland plants and soil, pollutants and sediments are trapped and broken down. This process cleans the water before it reaches rivers, lakes, and underground supplies. Many cities rely on nearby wetlands to help purify their drinking water naturally. [2] The filtering ability of wetlands saves communities millions of dollars that would otherwise be spent on water treatment, making wetland conservation a smart economic choice as well as an environmental one.

Wetlands also serve as natural flood barriers. During heavy rains, wetlands absorb and store large amounts of water, releasing it slowly over time. This reduces the risk of sudden flooding in surrounding areas. Coastal wetlands, such as mangrove forests, protect shorelines from storm surges and erosion. [3] By acting as natural sponges and buffers, wetlands reduce the damage caused by extreme weather events, a role that becomes more important as climate change brings heavier and more frequent storms.

Despite their importance, wetlands are disappearing at an alarming rate. More than half of the world's wetlands have been lost in the past century due to agriculture, urban development, and pollution. When wetlands are drained or filled in, the species that depend on them lose their homes, and the services they provide—water filtration, flood control, carbon storage—are lost too. [4] The destruction of wetlands has far-reaching consequences that affect not only wildlife but also the safety, health, and prosperity of the human communities that once benefited from them.

Conservation efforts are working to protect and restore wetlands around the world. International agreements such as the Ramsar Convention help governments identify and preserve important wetland sites. Local organizations plant native vegetation, remove invasive species, and educate communities about the value of these ecosystems. [5] Through a combination of policy, science, and community action, there is real hope that remaining wetlands can be preserved and damaged ones restored, ensuring their benefits continue for generations to come.

选项

A. Wetlands are among the most productive ecosystems on Earth, supporting an extraordinary range of life and performing essential services that benefit both nature and human communities. B. The filtering ability of wetlands saves communities millions of dollars that would otherwise be spent on water treatment, making wetland conservation a smart economic choice as well as an environmental one. C. By acting as natural sponges and buffers, wetlands reduce the damage caused by extreme weather events, a role that becomes more important as climate change brings heavier and more frequent storms. D. The destruction of wetlands has far-reaching consequences that affect not only wildlife but also the safety, health, and prosperity of the human communities that once benefited from them. E. Through a combination of policy, science, and community action, there is real hope that remaining wetlands can be preserved and damaged ones restored, ensuring their benefits continue for generations to come. F. For example, the Everglades in Florida is one of the largest wetlands in the world, covering over 7,500 square kilometers and serving as home to rare species such as the Florida panther and the American crocodile.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍湿地类型——沼泽、泥沼、泥塘，虽不如山海壮观但作用重要——过滤水源、减少洪水、提供栖息地，空后需概括湿地的生态价值。A的"most productive ecosystems on Earth"与"vital role"呼应，"supporting an extraordinary range of life and performing essential services"概括了前文三大功能。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说湿地充当天然水过滤器——水流经植物和土壤时污染物被捕获分解、净化后进入河湖地下水、许多城市依赖湿地净化饮水，空后需总结过滤功能的经济价值。B的"filtering ability of wetlands saves communities millions of dollars"将生态功能与经济效益联系，"smart economic choice as well as an environmental one"升华主题。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说湿地是天然防洪屏障——暴雨时吸收储存水、缓慢释放减少洪水风险、沿海红树林保护海岸，空后需总结防洪功能的重要性。C的"acting as natural sponges and buffers"概括吸水和缓冲功能，"a role that becomes more important as climate change brings heavier and more frequent storms"与气候变化联系。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：空前说湿地消失速度惊人——过去百年超半数消失、因农业城市化污染、物种失去家园、水过滤防洪碳储存等功能消失，空后需总结破坏的深远后果。D的"far-reaching consequences"概括前文多重损失，"affect not only wildlife but also the safety, health, and prosperity of... human communities"将影响扩展到人类社区。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：空前说保护努力——国际协议（拉姆萨尔公约）、政府保护重要湿地、本地组织种植植被、清除入侵物种、教育社区，空后需总结保护前景。E的"combination of policy, science, and community action"概括三方面努力，"real hope... preserved and damaged ones restored"是全文收尾的积极展望。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the Everglades in Florida is one of the largest wetlands in the world, covering over 7,500 square kilometers and serving as home to rare species such as the Florida panther and the American crocodile.**：以For example开头，为具体湿地案例（佛罗里达大沼泽地）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[1]易被误选因涉及物种多样性，但该空需概括湿地的整体生态价值，而非某个特定湿地的面积和物种数据。